Y2021 PROMOTION EXAMINATION FOR PRINCIPAL MANAGERS

TEST TYPE: PLANNING, STRATEGY AND LEADERSHIP
SITUATIONAL JUDGEMENT TEST

In this test you will be asked to imagine yourself in a number of different scenarios and roles. You will be presented with situations and asked to select the response you believe you would be 'most' and 'least' likely to make to these situations from a range of options. It is recommended you read all the possible responses before deciding how to respond

ANSWER ALL QUESTIONS
DURATION: 1 HOUR

Enable Immersive Reade

Points: 9/20

1. What is your full name *

[redacted]

Scenario 1

You are a Manager on a two-year training programme at the Benign Sunshine Agency. Benign Sunshine is the UK's fifth largest marketing agency and deals with all aspects of clients' marketing, market research, PR and advertising needs.

3. You have three days to go until the end of a project that you have been working on for the last four weeks in the market research team. By now you would usually have an email or call from your mentor letting you know about your next assignment location or your host team would have asked you to stay on for more time if they required you. However, neither of these things have happened and therefore you are unsure where you are going to be working next week or what your responsibilities will be.

   Review the following responses A to D and indicate which one you believe to be the response to the situation.

   Responses:
   (1/1 Point)

   A. Delay the end of this project for as long as you can.

   B. Ask your current team leader if she can assign some additional tasks to you to continue this placement a little longer.

   C. Do nothing, as you will be able to use the 'downtime' after this project ends to pursue some personal development without having to work on a project for a while.

   D. Email your mentor to remind him that you think you are due to move onto a new posting or project in 3 days' time. ✓

4. You have been asked to stay with the market research team for another project. Because of the competence you demonstrated on your last project in the team you have been given overall responsibility for a small piece of market research which Benign Sunshine have been commissioned to do by West Grimsdale Fire & Rescue Service (WGFRS).

   The Service wish to find out how many households in their region currently have smoke alarms fitted and are operational and, of those who don't, how many are willing to fit smoke alarms in the next 6 months either with or without incentives.

   Review the following responses A to D and indicate which one you believe to be the response to the situation.

   Responses:
   (1/1 Point)

Scenario 2

You are working as an interim manager for a production company that specialises in TV history and art documentaries. Your role is to support the staff at the company and learn aspects of the work they do in order to enhance your production skills and eventually apply for a job as a production assistant. The company is called Knowledgematic. It is a small organisation with two company Directors, four full-time production assistants and one administrator. Specialist Producers and TV Directors are hired on a freelance basis to work on specific projects.

You have been at Knowledgematic for three months and have yet to gain any experience in location filming. All your work has been studio-based and you are very keen to help out on a location shoot as this will enhance your CV for when you begin applying for permanent jobs.



6. You are aware the company is going to start filming a documentary about the Battle of Zaria next week and the first few weeks of the filming are going to be on location in Kaduna. You are very keen to be assigned to this project. However, George Folarin, one of the company directors has just approached you to ask that you take on a project to sort through and archive the video tapes, DVDs and film footage which is stored in the backroom at the Knowledgematic offices. He says that he thinks it could take a couple of weeks to go through everything, decide on what should be kept and then archive it properly. He would like you to start next week.

   Review the following responses A to D and indicate which one you believe to be the response to the situation.

   Responses:
   (0/1 Point)

   A. Be honest with George about your wishes and why you feel that it is important to you that you gain some experience on location. Ask him for his view on this and ask him whether there is any chance that you can spend some time on the Kaduna shoot before returning to the office to start your archiving project.

   B. Say you'd rather go to the location shoot in Kaduna as it would support your development more than doing the archiving.

   C. Agree to do the archiving project and ask George for a chance today to talk about your learning and development, specifically when you might get to do some location filming. ✓

   D. Agree to do the archiving project, hopefully another chance to experience location

8. . Knowledgematic have been given an open brief by Channel 5 to deliver a new art documentary strand to appeal to young people aged between 14 and 25 and which will be aired on weeknights at 7.30pm. Steve Grade, one of the Knowledgematic directors, has given you the task of recommending the topic that should be the opening programme in the series. You must choose the one that will have maximum appeal and draw the target viewers in.

You have to choose between 3 programmes that are currently in production but will all be completed in time for the series opener in a few weeks' time. The programmes are:

- All You Ever Wanted To Know About Graphic Novels But Were Afraid To Ask (A detailed look at the life and work of three of the most successful graphic novelists working today, including the creator of a series of novels that have been turned into a Hollywood blockbuster trilogy.)
- Graffiti and Street Art: A Modern Rebellion (Going undercover with Africa's secretive and passionate graffiti artists and revealing the true identity of Bintsy the most famous and highly-valued street artist in the world.)
- The Festival Season (Following an outdoor performance artist, Taylor Hip, working the Africa and Asia's summer festivals; joining her as she hangs out with bands, comedians and other performers to share views on art, drugs, wellies and all manner of 'festivally' things.)

Review the following responses A to D and indicate which one you believe to be the response to the situation.

Responses:
(0/1 Point)

A. Research the popularity of the three topics on the internet; looking at 'trending' topics on Twitter, fan sites and other information.

B. Give your recommendation based on which one most appeals to you as you are not that knowledgeable about art and therefore feel that you are an average viewer in that sense.

C. Do an online survey of people aged 14 to 25 and ask them which of the titles most appeals to them; recommend the title that is given the most votes. ✓

D. Look at the viewing figures for previous documentaries on terrestrial TV which had similar topics.

guidelines.
•Operating the cash register, taking money and dealing with credit card transactions. Completing all paperwork relating to food safety and stock taking requirements.
•Cleaning and preparing the work surfaces, tables and chairs as required throughout the day.

You work either an early (8am to 4pm) or late (12pm to 8pm) shift, 6 days a week. One assistant usually works the late shift and two work the early shift. The Branch Manager is usually in the shop from 10am to 6pm.



10. It is 12.30pm on a Friday. A customer has come into the shop and has been browsing the food counter for a few minutes looking rather impatient and dissatisfied. When you asked the customer how you might be able to help them they said that they are unable to eat wheat or dairy and are finding your selection of food limiting as it is mostly sandwiches and the one salad on offer is a cheese salad. They have also asked to purchase a soya latte coffee. Your shop does not offer soya milk as an alternative to cow's milk as there has not been a great demand for it in the past.

    Review the following responses A to D and indicate which one you believe to be the response to the situation.

    Responses:
    (0/1 Point)

    A. Apologise to the customer and say that unfortunately there is not much on Tradewinds' menu which will be appropriate for their diet but they could try the healthfood cafe on the High Street.

    B. Say that your colleague would be happy to freshly prepare a salad without any cheese and ask if the customer would be happy to wait for a few moments whilst you find out about the soy latte. Ask your manager if you can pop out to the nearby convenience store for some soya milk to make the latte. ✓

    C. Apologise for the lack of soya milk but offer to freshly prepare a salad without any dairy in it for the customer. Point out any other items in the shop that would be appropriate for their diet.

    D. Suggest the customer go to the healthfood cafe on the High Street and, when the customer has gone, suggest to your manager that your branch introduce soya milk as an alternative for customers and make some non-dairy salads for vegans and people with restricted diets.

12. You have asked your manager if you can work the late shift every day this week as you have to go to a class every morning in order to complete your food hygiene certificate. The shop closes at 7.30pm each day and the final half-hour of the shift is allocated to cashing up (counting the money, recording the amount and putting it in the safe overnight) and cleaning the kitchen area and shop in readiness for the following day. You have learnt on your course that the method of cleaning the kitchen surfaces at Tradewinds is not 'best practice' and to do it properly would add another 10 minutes on to the process.

Review the following responses A to D and indicate which one you believe to be the response to the situation.

Responses:
(0/1 Point)

A. Start cashing up at 7.20pm in order to make sure that you have the full half-hour to spend on the cleaning.

B. Talk to your manager and ask for an extra 10 minutes pay on the late shift so you can work until 8.10pm and finish the cleaning to the required standards.

C. Work as fast as you can to complete the cleaning to the required standard and quickly do the cashing up.

D. Commence the cleaning and cashing up as usual at 7.30pm but tackle the jobs in a reasonable order of priority. You could leave the least hygiene-critical parts of the shop until last, for example the chairs, tables and floor in the customer area. As long as you have wiped these down you could leave a note for the morning shift saying that they need to give the area a more thorough clean first thing in the morning. ✓

and ferry port although this has reduced in size recently with some of the space being reallocated to retail outlets, leisure and water- side recreation.
The graduate training programme lasts for 3 years with 20% of your time is spent doing coursework and study for an MSc in Public Service Management at Abuja University. This works out at approximately 1 day a week at University. The remainder of your time you are assigned on a project-by-project basis to work for various departments and functions in the Council. The projects range in duration from 1 to 9 months. When each project is complete you, your project manager and your graduate mentor complete an assessment of your performance, learning and development needs based on your work on the project.

✗

14. You are currently working on a project to plan the decorative planting schemes around the city for next year. These planting schemes use seasonal bedding plants, mixed borders and bulb schemes to create colour and interest throughout the year on the city's roadside verges, road islands and central reservations of major roads. Your team have just completed the outline plan for next year but have now heard that, due to Central Government budget cuts, Lokogoma has decided to reduce the budget for your project by 50%. You are going, as a representative of the decorative planting project group, to attend a meeting with the Assistant Director of Finance (ADF) and two councillor members of the Countryside & Horticulture Committee where they intend to explain their reasoning further and outline your new budget. Your team have asked you to strongly challenge the budget cut.

Review the following responses A to E and indicate which one you believe to be the response to the situation.

Responses:
(0/1 Point)

A. Send an email to the ADF and the two councillors before the meeting giving a reasoned and evidence-based argument for why the budget cut is not appropriate. Prepare this argument in a bullet-point sheet for you to refer to in the meeting. Include points about voter and visitor reactions to the urban landscape. ✓

B. Send a copy of "Encouraging Wildlife in Inner Cities" to each of the people with whom you will be meeting. It is a pamphlet that explains how roadside planting can encourage bats, birds and insects to thrive in the urban environment.

C. Call the Director of Finance and ask him to attend the meeting as you want to talk to the person with 'the final say'.

D. Ask for information from the Lokogoma Countryside & Wildlife Officer with regard to the impact that planting schemes have had on wildlife. Prepare a document outlining this information to take to the meeting.

16. Lokogoma City Council is in the process of tendering for a new secondary waste management contract. Currently 'Wastewarriors' (a mid-size specialist recycling company) provide the domestic kitchen food waste collection & recycling service for LCC. Their contract is due to expire in 2 months' time and a new contract needs to be awarded for the service. The current provider is competing for the contract along with 2 other companies.

You are on a project team which is responsible for analysing and comparing the competing bids. The competing companies have all put in closely comparable bids with regard to the statutory criteria of cost and service reliability (i.e. how likely they are to collect the food waste on schedule). Therefore your Project Manager has asked you to devise a matrix of other possible selection criteria for the council to use to discriminate between the bidders.

Review the following responses A to D and indicate which one you believe to be the response to the situation.

Responses:
(0/1 Point)

A. Consult a range of sources (including other Local Authorities, waste management industry experts, expert websites and previous LoSCC bid processes) and collate a longlist of possible criteria to present to your PM for discussion. ✓

B. Brainstorm ideas yourself 'from first principles'.

C. Ask 'Wastewarriors' to suggest a list of additional selection criteria.

D. Ask for a meeting or phone call with the LCC Head of Waste Management and pick their brains as to what criteria might be appropriate.

E. Gather a few other team members together for a brainstorming session to generate as many possible criteria as you can. Check this list against the expert information on the internet to provide a realistic list for presentation to your PM.



Greenwinds has recently introduced a 'one-rate' policy for all its energy packages. Customers will be charged the same rate per unit of electricity or gas regardless of their method of payment or when their peak usage of energy is. This has many advantages including, greater clarity of charging, no encouragement for use of electrical appliances at night, which can be unsafe, and no discrimination against people using pre-pay meters, pre- pay cards or monthly cheque payment, all of whom are traditionally the less prosperous customers.



18. A customer has come through to you with a complaint about Greenwinds billing system. He is a new customer who has used the Greenwinds Dual Fuel electricity and gas product for a month. He says that he wasn't told by the doorstep sales person when he signed up that the electricity would not be split into off-peak and peak rate units. With his previous supplier he had been used to maximising his energy use at night in order to benefit from the cheaper rate electricity. He was under the impression that he would be able to continue to do this with Greenwinds and now he is very upset as he has realised, upon receiving his first bill, that this is not the case.

    Review the following responses A to D and indicate which one you believe to be the response to the situation.

    Responses:
    (0/1 Point)

    A. Apologise for the confusion but state that the Greenwinds charging policy is clearly written on the joining contract and on the website.

    B. Apologise for the confusion and ask the customer for more detail about the sales conversation, including the salesperson's name or description. Say that you will ask your manager to investigate the way that the contract was sold and to look at whether any miscommunication had happened on the doorstep. Say you will get back to the customer on a daily basis to keep him updated of progress. ✓

    C. Apologise for the confusion and offer the customer a goodwill waiver of one month's standing charge.

    D. Apologise for the confusion and say that you are sorry to hear that he is feeling upset and hope that Greenwinds excellent service and eco-friendly product will make up for the initial misunderstanding in the long-run



20. Today is Monday. You had a team meeting this morning in which your Team Leader mentioned that Head Office was unhappy with current levels of customer satisfaction with the contact centre and that there has been a dip in service quality. She said that, therefore, she would be looking closely at the service quality report every week and is expecting an improvement. The way that the contact centre service quality is measured has recently been changed: a new customer satisfaction survey has been introduced which is emailed to customers. Mystery shoppers have also been employed to call at random and record the way that they are dealt with by contact centre staff.

Review the following responses A to D and indicate which one you believe to be the response to the situation.

Responses:
(1/1 Point)

A. Make an extra special effort to be warm, friendly and helpful to customers throughout the week.

B. Look at Greenwinds intranet 'service quality' site which outlines the new measurement methods in detail. Analyse the customer satisfaction questions and the mystery shopper criteria and change your behaviour, if necessary, to ensure that you are fulfilling these requirements.

C. Wait for a further briefing from your Team Leader. She usually sends a note round following the team meeting summarising what was said. You are hopeful that she will be more specific in this note as to what is required of you in order to improve the service quality ratings.

D. Ask for a quick chat with your Team Leader sometime today and find out from her what she feels will be the best way for you to contribute to the service quality targets. Make sure you are aware of the detail of the new customer satisfaction measure and the Mystery Shopper criteria before you talk to her. ✓

